Does Education **Pay?**

Hourly wages in Canada, 2025 · Statistics Canada Labour Force Survey

Ahmed Hemida

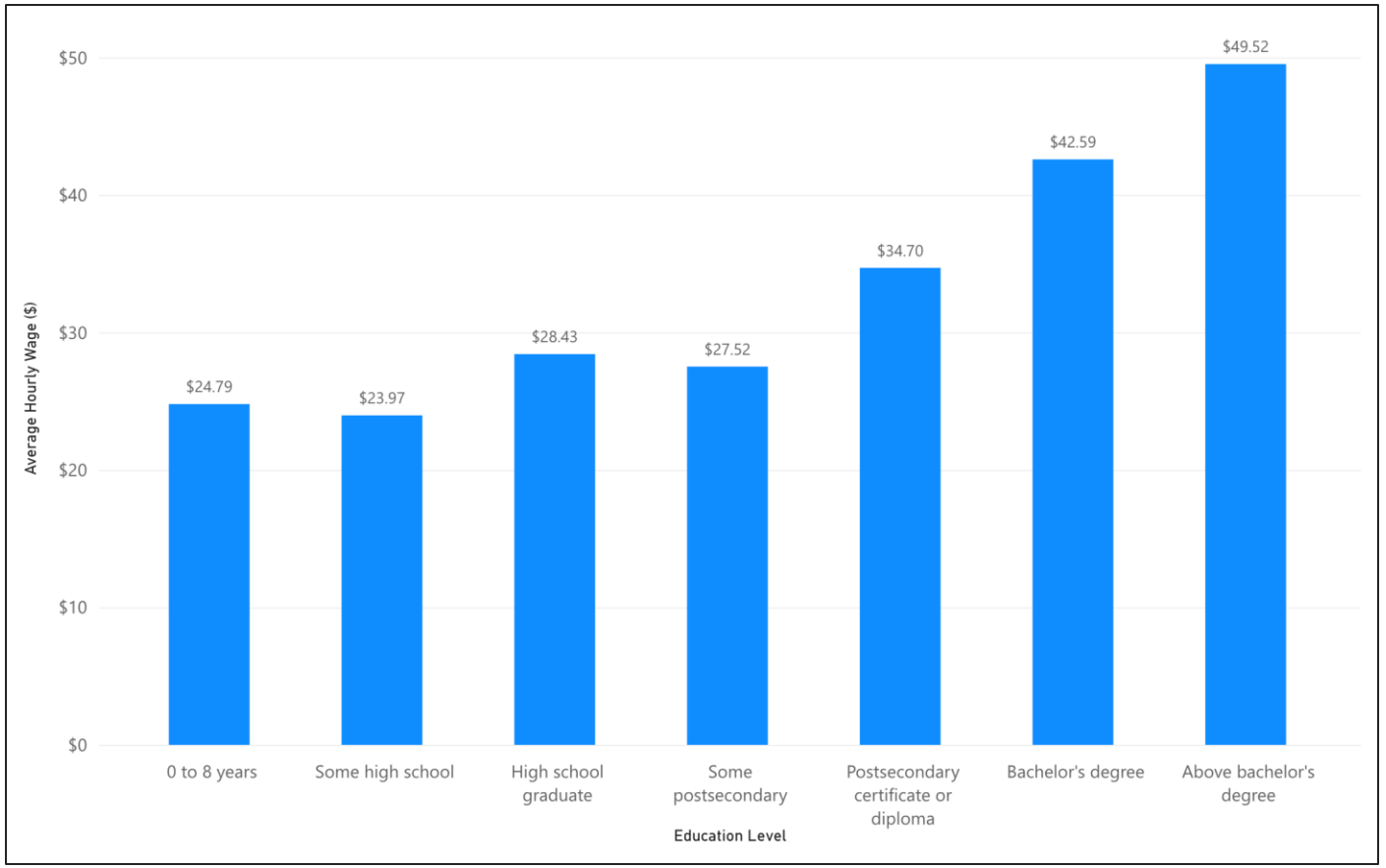
Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

The **Data**

- Statistics Canada Labour Force Survey, 2025 public-use file (12 monthly files)
- 1.36 million records, narrowed to the 688,793 employees who report an hourly wage
- Survey weights applied, so the results describe Canadian employees overall, not only the people sampled
- Python and PostgreSQL for loading and filtering, Excel for the weighted averages, Power BI for the charts

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

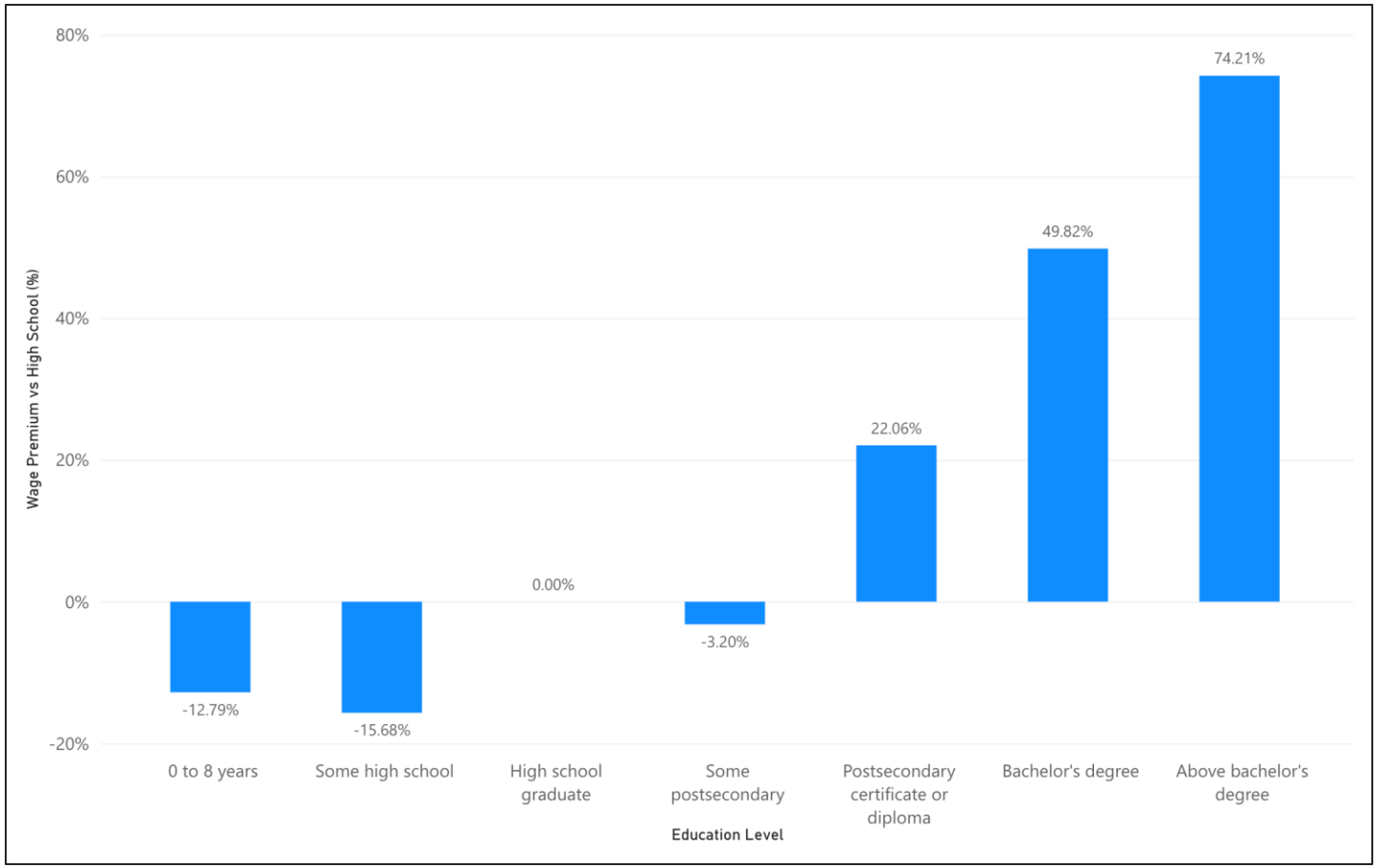
Wages Jump at the **Degree Level**



High school graduates **$28.43/h** · Bachelor's **$42.59/h** · Above bachelor's **$49.52/h**

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

A Bachelor’s Degree Pays About **50%** More Than High School

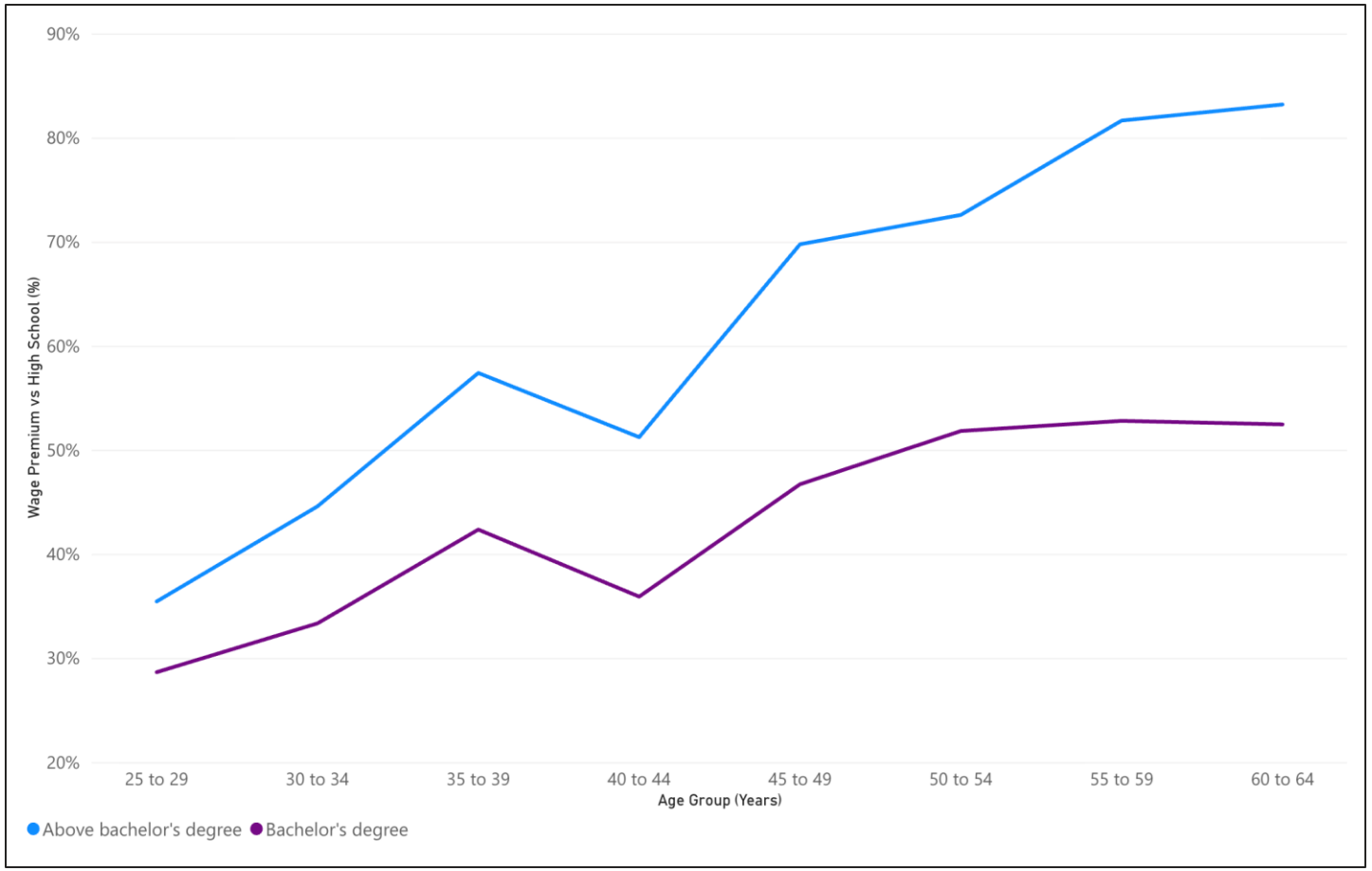


- Above Bachelor’s **+74%**
- Bachelor’s **+50%**
- Diploma or Certificate **+22%**
- Without a High School Diploma **13%** to **16%** Less

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

The Premium Holds Across Ages 25 to 64 and **Grows with Age**

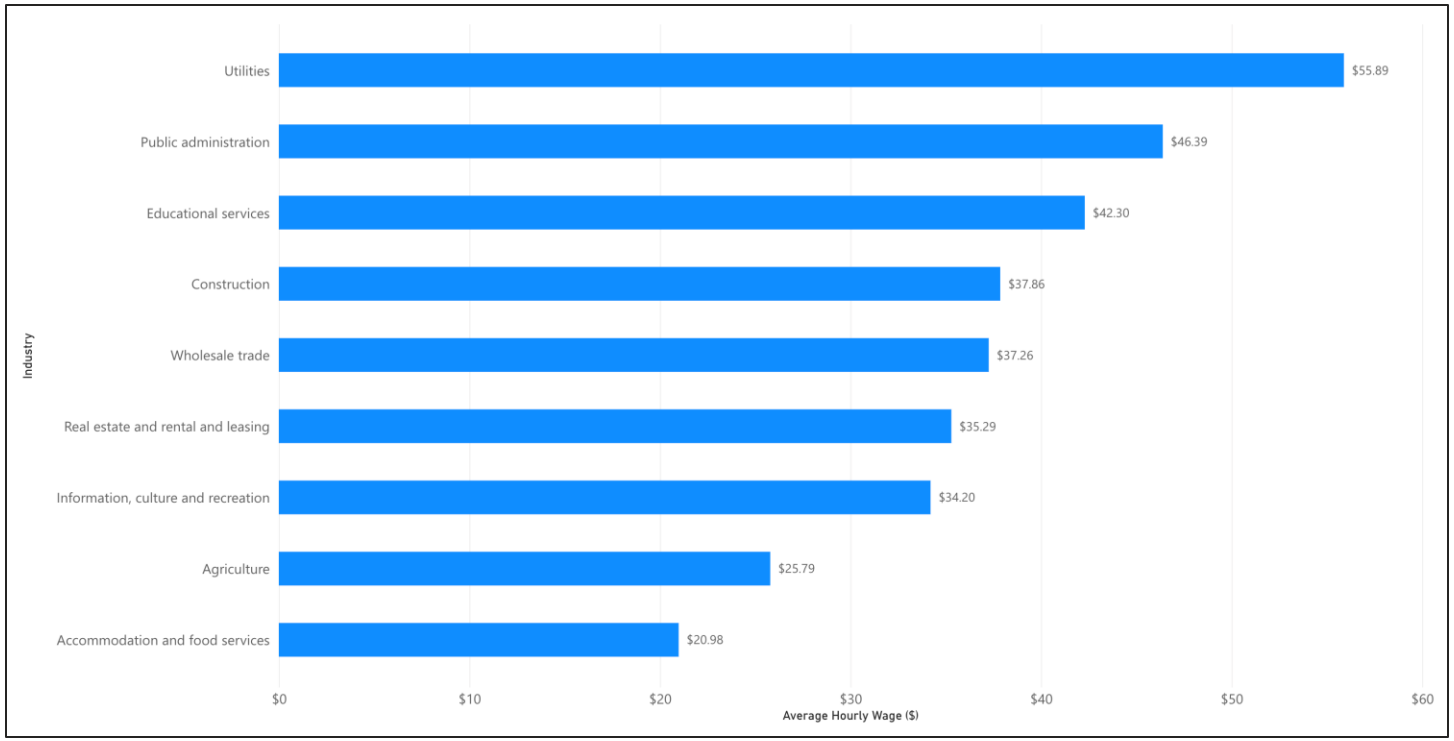
Each age group is compared with high school graduates of the same age



- Bachelor's: **+29%** at ages 25 to 29 → about **+52%** in the 50s
- Above bachelor's: **+35%** → **+83%** at ages 60 to 64

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

Where You Work **Matters Too**



- Utilities **$55.89/h** vs accommodation and food services **$20.98/h**, about **2.7 times** as much
- Firms with 500+ employees pay **$40.33/h** vs **$29.00/h** at firms under 20, about **39% more**
- Across provinces, British Columbia **$37.95/h** vs Prince Edward Island **$30.16/h**, about **26% more**

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.

Limits and Next Steps

Limits

- The results show a link between education and pay, not that education causes it
- Age is the only factor I held constant. Union status, industry and gender also affect wages
- Self-employed workers are left out because they have no hourly wage

Next Steps

- Account for industry, union status and gender
- Compare 2025 with earlier years
- Check whether the premium differs by province

Source: Statistics Canada, Labour Force Survey PUMF 2025.